cortex contains lymphocytes (mostly B cells), macrophages and follicular dendritic cells arranged in primary follicles. After antigenic challenge, the primary follicles enlarge into secondary follicles, each containing a germinal centre. Beneath the cortex is the paracortex which is populated largely by T lymphocytes and also interdigitating dendritic cells thought to have migrated from tissues to the node. These interdigitating dentritic cells express high levels of class II MHC molecules, which are necessary for presenting antigen to T helper (TH) cells. Lymph nodes are specialized to trap antigen from regional tissue spaces. As antigen is carried into a lymph node by the lymph, it is trapped, processed and presented together with class II MHC molecules by interdigitating dendritic cells in the paracortex, resulting in the activation of TH cells. Activated TH cells release cytokines needed for B cell activation. Thus lymph nodes represent one environment where B cells differentiate into memory cells and antibody – secreting plasma cells.

HOTS

What happens when thymus is removed from the human body?

c. MALT and SALT

The specialized lymphoid tissue in mucus membranes is called mucosal associated lymphoid tissue (MALT). There are several

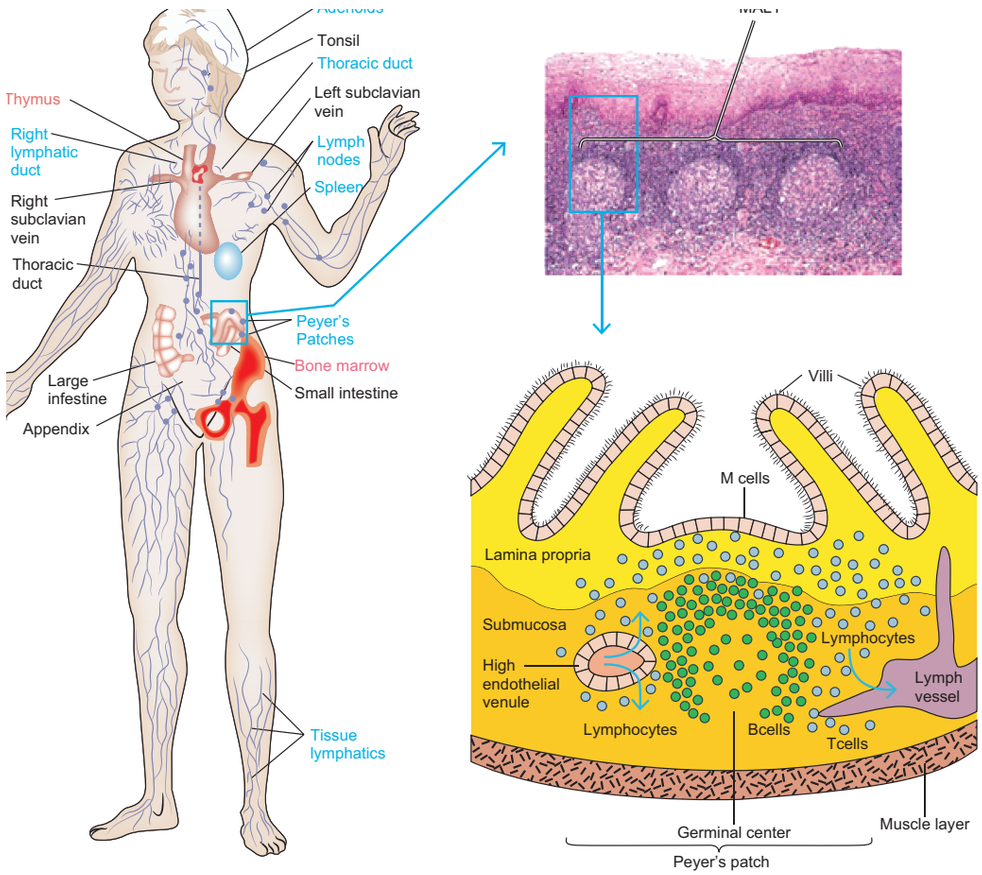


Figure 13.7: Malt Mucosa Associated Lymphoid Tissue (MALT)

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